

litres of hot water per wash. Choose aerators with a flow rate of no more than 3.8 litres per minute for your faucets, for maximum savings. Turn off the water heater when you leave the home as most models reheat the water to the set temperature in about an hour.

Energy monitors. These devices monitor and control appliances and lightings. Examples include Wiser Home Control, control4, Ted 5000, Onzo, Energy Hub, WeMo Insight Switch and Wink Hub. These let you schedule bulbs to turn on, off or dim throughout the day.

This helps you monitor and control the consumption of electric energy by different appliances via your smartphone. This also helps you to track the money saved, once you start using it.

Energy monitors can be of three types:

Timers and motion switches. These are used on light plugs or electrical outlets to control the amount of time electricity is running, for plugged-in devices or for lights that are switched on. These either have a dial to set the range of minutes or the range of preset times. These energy-saving devices have great use for bathroom fans, which you may want to run for some time after you leave

the bathroom, but which you do not want to run all day.

Motion-activated light switches sense movement or your body heat when you enter a room, and turn the power on when you pass the sensor. After the movement or heat is no longer detected, it is turned off.

Interlocks. These are used to prevent two or more large appliances, such as the air-conditioner and water heater, from running simultaneously.

Load controllers. These devices sense total electric demand within a home. These switch off electrical appliances in a predetermined sequence when programmed demand level is exceeded. The devices switch on electrical appliances in a predetermined sequence when demand is below the programmed level.

Smart power strips. These are smart power strips that sense used electric power. On sensing that the computer has been turned off, these automatically shut off the peripherals too, including printers, speakers and backup drives.

Some come with colour-coded outlets, including outlets for control, always-on outlets and automatically-switched outlets. When a device plugged into the control outlet (blue) is switched on, it powers up the automatically-switched outlets. When you power down a device, the smart strip automatically shuts down the power to the device's peripherals at switched outlets. When it begins to flow through the control outlet, power is restored to the switched outlets. This means the devices you are not using are not costing you any money. These are easily available



Smart power strip

in online and offline stores.

If you plug your TV in the control outlet and other accessories in switched outlets, the smart strip controls the accessories based on what the TV is doing. You can use the always-on outlets to connect devices that might need power even when the TV is off.

Tips for electricity conservation

Given below are a few tips for the conservation of electricity:

- Unplug battery chargers when not in use, or when batteries are fully-charged.
- Keep heat sources like lamps and TVs away from the air-conditioner thermostat, as this may cause it to run longer.
- Regularly defrost your freezer, as frost buildup increases the amount of energy needed to keep the refrigerator at its proper temperature.
- Look for a dishwasher with air power or overnight dry setting, because it turns off the dishwasher after the rinse cycle.
- Use light-activated switches for outdoor lights.

Little waste may amount to big losses and little savings can lead to huge gains. So let us practice the use of Energy-Star-approved appliances to give a better life to our future generation. **EFY**



WaterHawk showerhead (Credit: <https://digitized.house>)